

Understanding Analysis, 2nd Edition

Chapter 5 - Section 5.3 - The Mean Value Theorems

1. Recall from Exercise 4.4.9 that a function $f : A \rightarrow \mathbf{R}$ is Lipschitz on A if there exists an $M > 0$ such that

$$\left| \frac{f(x) - f(y)}{x - y} \right| \leq M$$

for all $x \neq y$ in A .

- (a) Show that if f is differentiable on a closed interval $[a, b]$ and if f' is continuous on $[a, b]$, then f is Lipschitz on $[a, b]$.
- (b) Review the definition of a contractive function in Exercise 4.3.11. If we add the assumption that $|f'(x)| < 1$ on $[a, b]$, does it follow that f is contractive on this set?

Solution:

- (a) Continuous function preserves compactness (Theorem 4.4.1) and compact sets are bounded. Since f' is continuous on $[a, b]$, it's bounded. Thus there exists $M > 0$ such that $|f'(c)| \leq M$ for all $c \in [a, b]$.

Now, by the Mean Value Theorem, for any $x \neq y$ in $[a, b]$, there exists t in $[a, b]$ such that

$$\frac{f(x) - f(y)}{x - y} = f'(t)$$

Therefore

$$\left| \frac{f(x) - f(y)}{x - y} \right| = |f'(t)| \leq M$$

as required.

- (b) f is contractive if there exists a constant $0 \leq c < 1$ such that $|f(x) - f(y)| \leq c|x - y|$ for all $x, y \in \mathbf{A}$.

The answer is yes. From part (a), we have

$$|f(x) - f(y)| = |f'(t)||x - y|$$

And we have $|f'(t)| < 1$.

But we need to choose a single constant c (whereas $|f'(t)|$ depends on x and y). From part (a), f' is continuous on a compact set $[a, b]$ so it attains a maximum.

Choose $c = \max_{x \in [a, b]} |f'(x)|$. Since $|f'(x)| < 1$ on $[a, b]$ from the problem's assumption, the contractive condition is satisfied.

2. Let f be differentiable on an interval A . If $f'(x) \neq 0$ on A , show that f is one-to-one on A . Provide an example to show that the converse statement need not be true.

Solution: We prove the contrapositive. Suppose f is not one-to-one, then there exists $a < b$ in A such that $f(a) = f(b)$. By the Mean Value Theorem, there exists $c \in A$ such that

$$\frac{f(b) - f(a)}{b - a} = 0 = f'(c)$$

so f' cannot be non-zero on all of A .

Counterexample to the converse: x^2 on $[0, 1]$. It's one-to-one (because we exclude negative domain) with $f'(0) = 0$.

Alternatively, a cleaner counterexample that doesn't involve one-sided derivative is x^3 .